BUILDYYC

Workshop 2

BUILD BETTER

SIMON LOEWEN

SpaceX & Grok Ambassador,
AI Strategist @ TerraLink Horticulture

Simon Loewen is an AI strategist and the Sales Intelligence Manager at TerraLink Horticulture, where he gives company leadership high-level guidance on strategy and growth. Through New Era AI, he and his team build custom SaaS and automations that help businesses work more effectively. Simon is also the SpaceXAI Ambassador for Calgary, growing local adoption of Cursor and Grok Bot



BUILDYYC · WORKSHOP 02 · OCT 23 2026

Build Better: the AI product loop



Simon Loewen

· Co-founder, New Era Intelligence

· Sales Intelligence Manager, Terralink Horticulture

· SpaceXAI Ambassador

SPACEX CURSOR Grok Bot PLATFORM calgary PRODUCT CALGARY

WHAT TO EXPECT · MY SECRET SAUCE

SaaS production: my full workflow, in detail

My full AI-centric build workflow and process, end to end



TONIGHT'S FOCUS

01	02	03	04	05
PRD	Build	Ship	Maintain	GTM

TONIGHT · 45 MINUTES

01 Who I am and what to expect · 4 min

02 Planning, Creating the PRD · 7 min

03 Building workflow · 15 min

04 After the build · 5 min

05 AI automation with Grok Bot · 7 min

06 Product ops and GTM · 7 min

02 / Plan with a reasoning model

Planning, Creating the PRD



Files and research in. PRD out.

WHY CONTEXT MATTERS · HYPER-PERSONALISED SAAS

AI defaults to generic. Context allows for precision towards a desired outcome

Reuse the ICP and customer discovery from your PRD as context.

LAYER 1

Industry

The rules, language and workflows of your field

LAYER 2

Business

Your ICP (ideal customer profile), customer discovery and business plan

LAYER 3

Individual

Each user's role, goals and habits

Domain expertise

RESULT

Your product

Context refines the build and the product

PLAN WITH A THINKING MODEL

Context in, PRD out

WHAT I GIVE IT

Files plus a research ask

Spreadsheets, PDFs and notes

Research on the industry, company or product area

HOW IT FLOWS

- ✓ **Drop in your files**
- ✓ **Ask for research**
- ✓ **Research comes back as context**
- ✓ **Turn it into a PRD**
- ✓ **Bring the PRD and data into your IDE**

03 / BUILD FROM THE PRD

Building workflow

PRD and context data into your IDE. Agents plan and build.



BUILD IN AN AI IDE OR CODING AGENT

Pick your builder

HOW I BUILD

Cursor

Agents, cloud agents, MCP tools and plugins

All in one editor

PEERS

- **Claude Code**
- **Antigravity**
- **Codex**
- **Lovable**

BUILD SMARTER

CURSOR

Right model, right job

REASONING MODELS

PRD, hard tasks

PRD and complex tasks

GPT-5.6 Sol, Claude Opus 5.5

FAST CODING MODELS

Everyday edits

Quick, cheap edits and tests

Composer 2.5, GPT-5.6 Luna

FRONTIER CODING MODELS

Big builds

Multi-file features, long runs

Astra 6, Claude Fable 5.5

COST AND QUALITY

Why it matters

Wrong model wastes money

Or let Cursor Auto pick

BUILD WITH CURSOR

CURSOR

Plan before you code

BEFORE ANY CODE

Gather API keys, tokens, MCP servers and plugins

Set up everything agents need to reach outside tools

Keep secrets in env files, never in chat

THEN PLAN MODE

- ✓ **Agent asks clarifying questions**
- ✓ **Researches your codebase**
- ✓ **Writes a methodical plan, no code yet**
- ✓ **You review and edit the plan**

BUILD WITH CURSOR

CURSOR

From PRD to working code

01
PRD and API keys into Cursor

02
Plan Mode: a methodical plan

03
Agents take tasks from the plan

04
You review and test

BUILD WITH CURSOR

CURSOR

Agents that build, test and review for you

01

MCP tools

Query your database, repo and docs

02

Cloud agents

Cloud VMs that build, test and screenshot

03

Bugbot code review

Reviews every PR for bugs and security

04

Project and user rules

.cursor/rules, AGENTS.md
User rules in every project

AI NATIVE INFRASTRUCTURE

A backend your agents can operate

01

Core pieces

GitHub for repos, PRs and Actions
Auth, Stripe, Twilio, logs and secrets

02

Hosting

Render, Vercel, Netlify, Railway
Deploy from GitHub
Preview deploys and env vars

03

Data and backend

Supabase for Postgres, auth, storage and edge functions
Or Render Postgres, plain Postgres

INSIDE MY SAAS · PLATFORM

Infrastructure & building framework

CODE AND CI

GitHub, Cursor Origin

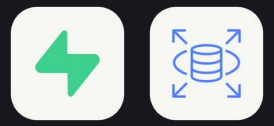
Repos, PRs and CI



AUTH AND DATABASE

Supabase, AWS

Sign in, Postgres and RDS



DOCS

Context7

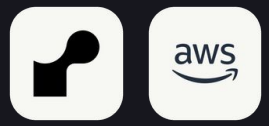
Up-to-date docs for my coding agents



HOSTING

Render, AWS

Web services, cron jobs and Postgres
AWS for Bedrock



INSIDE MY SAAS · AI AND COMMS

Integrations and embedded tools

LLM APIS

OpenAI, Grok, Claude Design

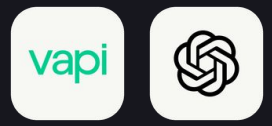
Copilots, screening, roleplay and scoring



VOICE AGENTS

Vapi, OpenAI Realtime

Phone and web voice agents



PHONE, SMS AND EMAIL

Twilio, Resend

Calls, alert texts and app email



PAYMENTS

Stripe

Taking payments



PROTOTYPE DATA · HOW REAL IS IT

Demo, synthetic or live data

01 · EASIEST

Demo mode

Fixed, static screens
Shows the system with data in it

02 · MIDDLE GROUND

Synthetic data

Generated data runs the real system
No real users or records needed

03 · MOST COMPLEX

Live data

Online and fully working
Real users, real data

MORE COMPLEX



MORE REAL WORLD READY



MOBILE DEVELOPMENT

Expo

Mobile apps with Expo

01

One codebase, shared backend

React Native for iOS and Android

Test on your phone with Expo Go

02

Cloud builds

EAS Build runs in the cloud

No Mac needed for iOS builds

03

Ship and update

EAS Submit sends builds to the stores

Over the air updates for quick fixes

MOBILE DEVELOPMENT

The Android process

HOW I SHIP IT

Cursor plus the Expo API

I build in Cursor

EAS builds and submits to Google Play Console



GOOGLE PLAY CHECKLIST

- ✓ Google Play developer account
- ✓ App created in Play Console
- ✓ Internal testing
- ✓ Closed testing, then production
- ✓ Store listing, privacy policy and data safety form

MOBILE DEVELOPMENT

The Apple process

HOW I SHIP IT

Same Cursor plus Expo flow

I build in Cursor

EAS builds and submits

TestFlight, then App Store review in App Store Connect



APPLE CHECKLIST

- ✓ **Apple Developer Program membership**
- ✓ **App record in App Store Connect**
- ✓ **Bundle ID and signing, via EAS**
- ✓ **TestFlight for testers**
- ✓ **Privacy details and a policy URL**
- ✓ **App Store review**

MY MOBILE FLOW

From code to the store



Expo







01
Cursor agent writes code

02
EAS build via the Expo API

03
TestFlight

04
Review, then the store

04 / RUN AND MAINTAIN

After the build

Debug, monitor and maintain your MVP, with always-on agents.



05 / AUTOMATION THAT SUPPORTS THE PRODUCT

AI automation with Grok Bot

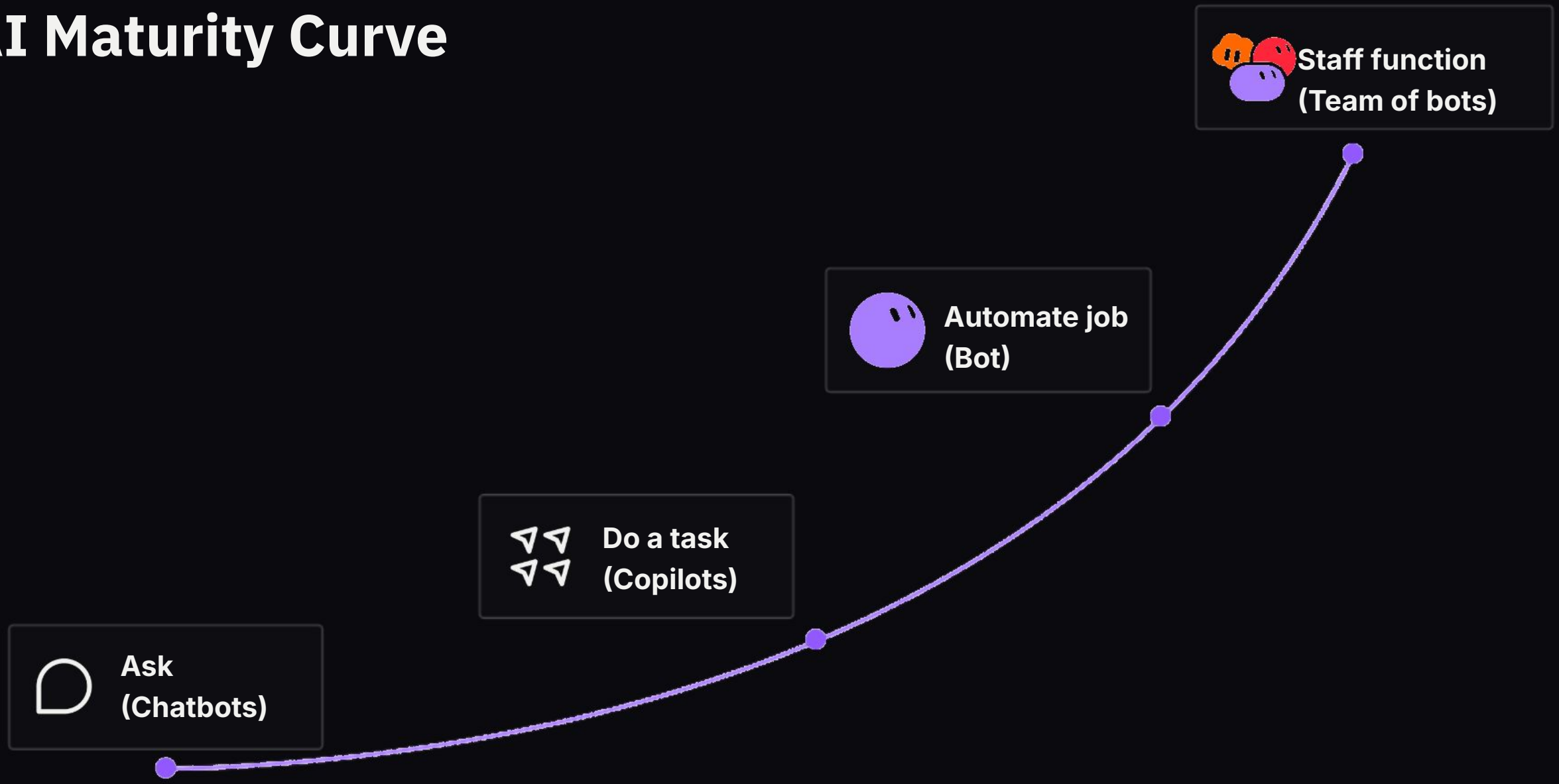


Grok Bot

I use Grok Bot for events, logistics and slides.

Fun fact: Grok Bot built this whole deck, through its Canva connector

AI Maturity Curve



MEET GROK BOT

How it works

COMPUTER

Own computer

Cloud computer with a browser, files and a terminal
Keeps working with your laptop closed

CONNECTORS

Your apps

Gmail, Slack, Calendar, Drive, GitHub and more
The browser covers the rest

ROUTINES

Runs on its own

Runs on a schedule or a trigger
Triggers like a webhook or a pull request

TEAMWORK

A team of bots

Bots message each other
They share context and pass work along

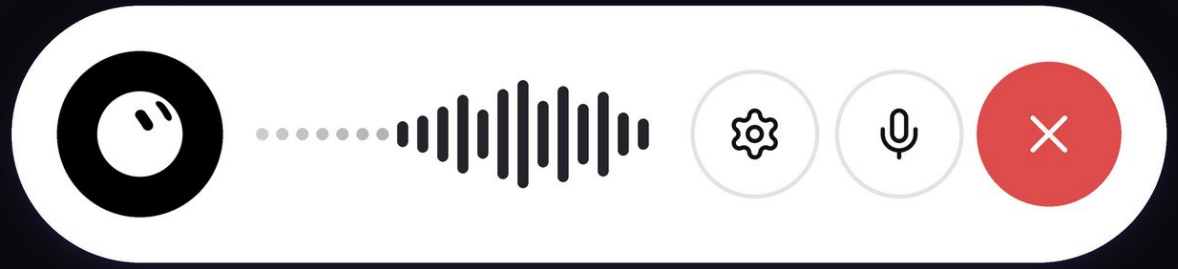
PEERS

Meta Muse
OpenAI Dots
Gemini Spark
Hermes*
OpenClaw*

* Locally hosted (not cloud-based)



Introducing Grok Bot



Building events

My Sept 30 meetup

1. Slack updates and action items
2. Catering follow-ups
3. Print vendor coordination
4. Luma management and guest updates

The bot drafts,
I approve before anything goes out



Grok Bot CURSOR

06 / Product ops

Product ops and GTM



Refine and validate what we built, then take it to market.

Grok Bot

EMPATHIUM UPDATER

Monitoring



Hourly homepage and DNS health checks

Quiet when green, alerts on real outages

GITHUB TESTER

Testing



Polls pushes to my repos every half hour

Tests each push

SYSTEM REVIEWER

Product review

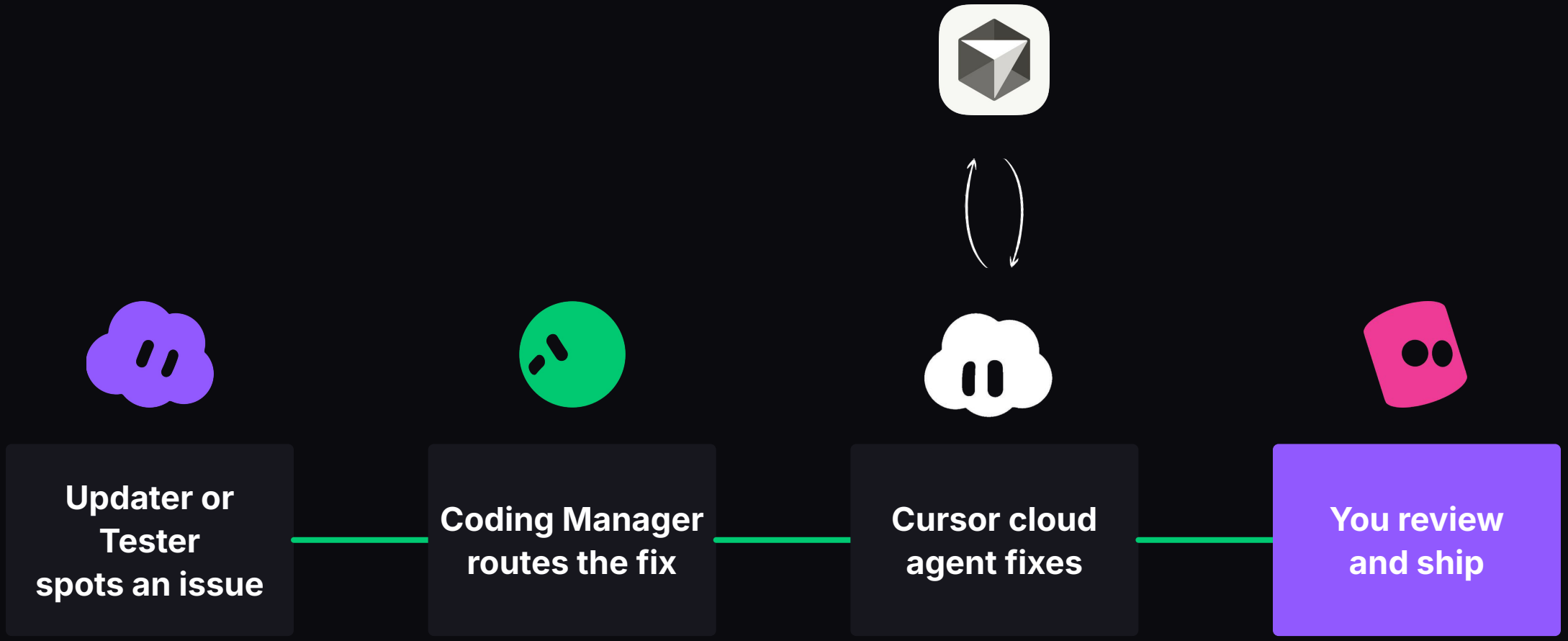


Walks my live Render apps page by page

Writes product direction reports on UX and flow problems

CLOSING THE LOOP

Grok Bot



SELL, MARKET AND PROMOTE

Where agentic automation can help with GTM



OUTREACH

Outreach drafts

Drafted for your approval before anything is sent

SOCIAL

Social posts

Draft posts for launches and updates

RESEARCH

Competitor research

Tracks competitors' features, pricing and launches

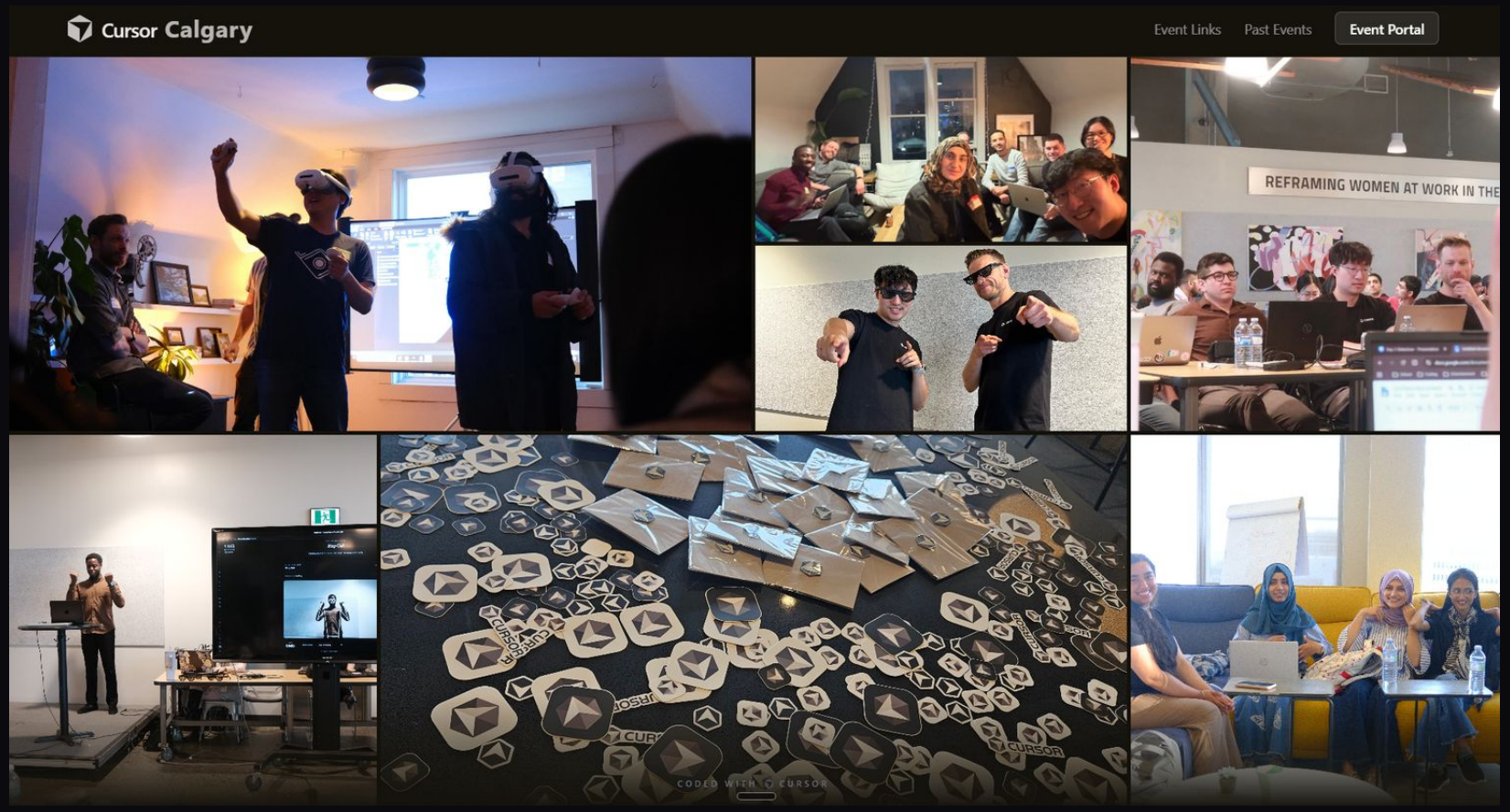
ROUTINES

Follow-ups

Weekday action items and follow-ups

Monthly Meetups

SPACEX



EVENTS IN 2026

12+

Calgary community events this year.

COMMUNITY

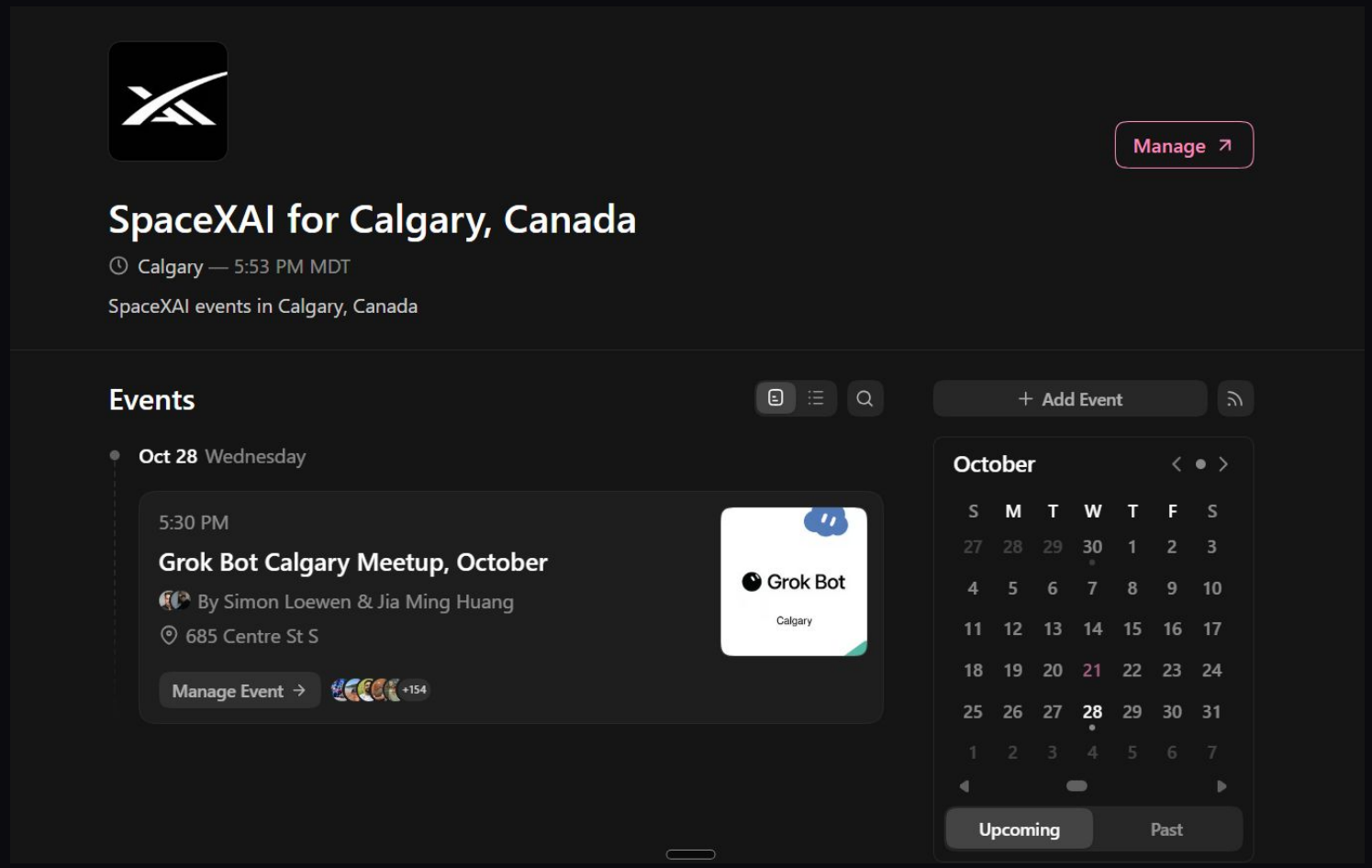
~1,000

Calgary builders reached in 9 months.

CREDITS

$100K+

In credits given to Calgary builders.



Grok Bot CURSOR

Thank you!

Now go build something awesome.



SPACEX CURSOR Grok Bot PLATFORM calgary PRODUCT CALGARY